Uses of Silk

Silk has natural beauty and elegance. It gives comfort in warm weather and warmth during colder months. It is used in the manufacture of classical and high fashion clothes, modern dresses particularly silk sarees, the elegant of beautiful dresses. It is also used in household for making wall hangings, curtains, rugs and carpets. It is also being used in the manufacture of surgical threads for sutures.

India is the world's second largest silk producing country. Kancheepuram, Thirubhuvanam and Arani are famous places for silk production in Tamil Nadu.

5.3 Hazards in Silk and Wool Industry

Hazard is any industry has the potential to cause injury, ill health or damage to human being and their property or the environment.

Hazards in Silk Industry

Generally, the workers in silk industry affected with arthritis is they stand for a long time reeling the silk into yarn. They also develop back pain and visionary problem and skin injuries. Some time they may suffer from respiratory problem like asthma and bronchitis due to poor ventilated area of their work.

Similarly, hazards in wool industry the workers are exposed to various chemicals and detergents which causes allergies of the skin. They also get infected to anthrax bacterium which leads to fatal dead disease called the sorters disease.

Anthrax is caused by *Bacillus anthracis* by handling contaminated animal hair and contact with the live stock during hair processing. The symptoms are fever, cough and shortness of breath, similar to a typical pneumonia. Sometimes it may leads to nausea, vomiting and diarrhoea.

Treatment

- Pencillin or Ciprofloxacin is given as the best medicine for treatment of anthrax.
- The spread of the disease is controlled by vaccination of animals and by burning or burial of infected animal's carcases.
- It is the duty of the employer to take care of the industrial workers by providing hygienic and well ventilated work place.

Sericulture and Ahimsa silk (Peace silk)

Sericulture or silk farming is the cultivation of silk worm to produce silk. It is the rearing of silk worms to obtain silk.

Ahimsa silk

It is also known as Peace silk. In 1992, Kusuma Rajaiah, a Government officer from Andhra Pradesh state of India proposed ahimsa way of silk production for the making silks without killing the silkworm. It involves a humane method specifically letting the worms to hatch and then using the vacant cocoons.

Traditional silk manufacturing methods involve boiling the cocoons of the silk worms and then sorting out the threads, which is used later in silk production. It has been supported by many people who are interested in the welfare of animals.

5.4 Animal protection and maintenance

Protecting animals is like protecting our own children

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